

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mr Ilyas Shirwani

Address: 4 Heyward Court Overton Road Sutton SM2 6JY

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I am writing to express my strong support for the proposed change of use of the former ambulance centre into a community hub.

The proposal would deliver a meaningful and much-needed community asset for Belmont, Cheam and the wider Sutton area. Accessible indoor spaces for structured community activity have reduced in recent years, and this development would provide a managed venue capable of supporting a wide range of positive uses including educational programmes, youth engagement, health and wellbeing initiatives, and social activities for residents of all ages.

Facilities of this nature play an important role in strengthening social cohesion and addressing challenges such as isolation among elderly residents, limited safe spaces for young people, and the need for affordable venues for community-led initiatives. A permanent and properly managed centre would also reduce reliance on temporary or informal arrangements currently used for gatherings and community activities.

The proposal represents an appropriate reuse of an existing building and would enhance local provision without altering the character of the surrounding area.

In relation to parking concerns, it is worth noting that daily prayer times do not coincide with peak school drop-off and collection periods at Avenue School. The only overlap occurs during the Friday congregational prayer, which is already held locally at St John's Community Hall. Relocating this to a site with designated on-site parking has the potential to reduce pressure on surrounding residential streets rather than increase it.

Overall, the development would provide clear community benefit, improve access to organised local services, and contribute positively to wellbeing and engagement within the area.

For these reasons, I fully support the proposal.